



JUSTIFICATION FOR AN EXCEPTION TO FAIR OPPORTUNITY UNDER INDEFINITE DELIVERY/INDEFINITE QUANTITY (IDIQ) CONTRACTS

Solicitation 47QFCA26R0005

Mission Awareness Capabilities Ramp-up and Optimization (MACRO) Bridge

in support of:

**United States (U.S.)
Department of Defense (DoD)**



**United States (U.S.) General Services Administration (GSA)
Federal Acquisition Service
Assisted Acquisition Services (AAS) Army**

Interagency Agreement Number [REDACTED]

Controlled by AAS Contracting Officer [REDACTED]

[REDACTED]

The General Services Administration (GSA) Assisted Acquisition Services (AAS) makes this Justification for the issuance of an Exception to Fair Opportunity order pursuant to Federal Acquisition Regulation (FAR) 16.5 (GSA Class Deviation RFO-2025-16).

a. Identification of Agency and Contracting Activity:

Agency:

GSA AAS acting in support of United States (U.S.) Department of Defense (DoD)

Contracting Activity:

GSA AAS Contracting Office (QFAB)

1800 F Street, NW

Washington, D.C. 20405

b. Nature and/or Description of Action Being Approved:

The United States (U.S.) Department of Defense (DoD) and AAS Contracting Office propose to issue a sole source bridge Task Order (TO) under the ASTRO Multiple Award (MA) Indefinite Delivery/Indefinite Quantity (IDIQ) Development/Systems Integration Pool contract vehicle to support Mission Awareness Capabilities Ramp-up and Optimization (MACRO) bridge requirements. This action will be executed pursuant to an exception to fair opportunity under FAR 16.507-6(b)(1) (GSA Class Deviation RFO-2025-16). The sole source bridge TO will include Cost-Plus-Fixed-Fee (CPFF) Contract Line Item Numbers (CLINs) for Labor and Cost Reimbursable CLINs for Long-Distance Travel, Materials and Equipment, and Other Direct Costs (ODCs). This effort will provide continued support to the DoD for comprehensive system engineering services support including Program Management, Analytical and Execution Planning (AEP) Services, Engineering, Development, Integration, and Sustainment (EDIS) Services, Test and Evaluation (T&E) Services, and Training Support.

AAS is actively pursuing a new acquisition, the Integrated, Next-Generation, Versatile, Intelligence, Capabilities, Technologies, and Applications (INVICTA) TO, to continue the performance of the requirements under the MACRO TO. However, due to funding constraints, organizational restructuring amongst civilian agencies and DoD commands, and evolving mission priorities within the U.S. Army, this competitive TO will not be awarded in time to avoid a gap in service. This requirement is currently being supported by Applied Research Associates, Inc. (ARA) through the MACRO TO, which is set to expire on March 29, 2026, after exercising all viable option periods [REDACTED]

[REDACTED]
[REDACTED]
[REDACTED]
[REDACTED]

[REDACTED] Use of a sole-source Bridge TO allows for the continuation of proven effective and essential support until award of the competitive INVICTA TO.

c. Description of Supplies/Services and Estimated Value:

The scope of this effort is to provide comprehensive specialized engineering services for equipping the warfighter [REDACTED]

[REDACTED]

[REDACTED]

[REDACTED] The work to be performed under the bridge contract is intended to sustain the scope of work being performed under the current MACRO TO. The primary place of performance is Fort Belvoir, Virginia. Performance will also occur at multiple locations in the Continental United States (CONUS) and Outside the Continental United States (OCONUS). [REDACTED]

[REDACTED] The planned period of performance is a 6-month base period with 1, 6-month option.

Any service interruption would critically undermine mission critical objectives that address immediate operational requirements. [REDACTED]

[REDACTED]

[REDACTED]

[REDACTED]

[REDACTED]

[REDACTED]

[REDACTED]

[REDACTED]

The services will include the following task areas:

Task 1: Program Management Support

This task includes the management and oversight of all activities performed by contractor personnel such as facilitating Government and contractor communications; using industry best standards and proven methodologies to track and document TO requirements and activities; and ensuring all support and requirements performed are accomplished in accordance with the TO.

Task 2: Analytical and Execution Planning (AEP) Services

This task includes providing analytical and execution planning expertise to identify new capabilities and counter emerging threats. The task will include conducting analysis; devising and recommending potential solutions for the Government's review; conducting Cost Benefit Analysis; and scheduling for prototyping, integration, demonstration, and assessment to upgrade, enhance, or develop ETAK technologies and capabilities.

Task 3: Engineering, Development, Integration, Sustainment (EDIS) Services

This task includes EDIS services for the Government's approved ETAK solutions in the areas of software and hardware development upon review of the Analysis Report, Execution Plan, and other sources of input and consideration.

Task 4: Assessment, Experimentation, and Demonstration (AED) Services

This task includes field experimentation conducted on hardware, software, and operational concepts and vulnerability assessments on hardware and software as well as operational demonstration services during an operational experiment, exercise, or evaluation as required by the Government.

Task 5: Training Support

This task includes developing training documentation as well as providing training for demonstrations, exercises, operational systems training, and mission training.

[REDACTED]

[REDACTED]

d. Identification of the Exception to Fair Opportunity and Rationale:

This Task Order (TO) Justification is being prepared as required by: FAR 16.507-6(b)(1) (GSA Class Deviation RFO-2025-16), Exception to Fair Opportunity Process.

The rationale is as follows:

The order must be issued on a sole-source basis because the agency need for the supplies or services is so urgent that providing a fair opportunity would result in unacceptable delays FAR 16.507-6(b)(1) (GSA Class Deviation RFO-2025-16). If not prevented, these delays will significantly increase the risk of mission failure for the U.S. Army, and the DoD since MACRO services directly impact national security interests and the readiness of the U.S. Armed Forces.

The Headquarters, Department of the Army (HQDA) G2 serves as the primary staff element for military intelligence, counterintelligence, and security operations. [REDACTED]

[REDACTED]
[REDACTED]
[REDACTED]
[REDACTED]
[REDACTED]
[REDACTED]

[REDACTED] The Enterprise TAK (ETAK) is supported through the MACRO TO represents a warranted solution that allows Government TAK operators to rapidly develop capabilities for emerging needs while managing the enterprise program in a single, coordinated effort.

Under the current MACRO TO, [REDACTED]
[REDACTED]
[REDACTED]
[REDACTED]
[REDACTED]
[REDACTED]
[REDACTED]
[REDACTED]
[REDACTED]

The current MACRO TO 47QFCA20F0022 period of performance under Federal Acquisition Regulation (FAR) 52.217-8, Option to Extend Services will conclude on March 29, 2026. AAS initially anticipated making a competitive TO award on a new acquisition- INVICTA, to support the evolving mission landscape under an integrated, enterprise-level TO in September 2026. Consequently, the evolving acquisition priorities inflicted the need for the MACRO TO Bridge to allow solicitation development based on significant delays in awarding the INVICTA TO. The INVICTA TO award is scheduled for January 2027.

The justification for this follow-on sole source bridge TO [REDACTED]
[REDACTED]
[REDACTED]
[REDACTED]

[REDACTED]

[REDACTED]

While the bridge TO will cover essential tasks necessary to maintain continuity, its anticipated value is lower than the original award, due to funding constraints along with specific agencies' current efforts being completed and not anticipated to be re-initiated until a new, fully competed TO is awarded. This limited effort ensures operational continuity while avoiding duplication of effort.

The Government has pursued competitive procedures to the maximum extent practicable in order to fulfill the DoD's requirements, but there is not enough time before the expiration of the MACRO TO in order to award the INVICTA TO. Despite the fact that a competitive award has been pursued by the Government, the only way to ensure that there is not a lapse in mission essential services is to execute a bridge TO. Given the length of time needed to complete a competitive bridge acquisition with a competitive acquisition already in progress, the amount of time required for a competitive bridge would be unacceptable and the costs associated would be excessive and duplicative to the Government.

The proposed sole source acquisition would be awarded to ARA. As the incumbent on the MACRO TO, ARA has demonstrated its ability to fulfill the DoD and HQDA G2's requirements and ensure that mission essential activities are performed successfully. The DoD's need for continuity of the services completed under the MACRO TO is so urgent that providing a fair opportunity would result in unacceptable delays FAR 16.507-6(b)(1) (GSA Class Deviation RFO-2025-16).

[REDACTED]

[REDACTED]. The proposed sole source award to ARA is necessary to mitigate these risks and maintain mission essential services. Consequently, this sole source bridge TO is an urgent acquisition required to sustain critical operations without interruption.

e. Determination That the Anticipated Cost is Fair and Reasonable:

The most recent historical cost and fee data will be used in conjunction with any Forward Pricing Rate Agreement (FPRA) and other sources to determine a fair and reasonable price. The incumbent is a well-established contractor with approved accounting and purchasing systems. The Government utilized invoices and actual costs to establish an accurate Independent Government Cost Estimate (IGCE). A cost realism analysis will be conducted on the incumbent's proposal to evaluate whether proposed costs are realistic for the work to be performed, reflect a clear understanding of the requirements, and are consistent with the technical approach. This analysis will support the determination that the proposed costs are fair and reasonable for the scope and nature of the effort. It is anticipated that transitioning from a Cost-Plus-Award-Fee (CPAF) to a CPFF contract type will reduce contractor risk and thus reduce the associated fee. Additional cost savings are expected from using the ASTRO IDIQ, which does not include a Contract Access Fee (CAF).

f. Other Facts Supporting the Justification:

There are no other facts.

g. Statement of Actions:

To remove the barriers that led to this exception to fair opportunity, the agency has already initiated a competitive acquisition for the follow-on competitive Integrated, Next-Generation, Versatile, Intelligence, Capabilities, Technologies, and Applications (INVICTA) TO, with an estimated award date of September 2026. The sole source MACRO bridge TO is limited to a 6-month base period with 1, 6-month option that maintains continuity of services while allowing sufficient time for the competitive award process, resolution of any possible protests, and an appropriate transition from the incumbent contractor to the new awardee. Furthermore, the agency commits to improved task order monitoring, planning, and forecasting practices to further anticipate acquisition lead times and reduce reliance on the non-competitive bridge. These improvements include definition of earlier requirements, closer coordination between technical and contracting teams, and more rigorous tracking of performance and schedule milestones.

h. Certification by Technical or Requirements Personnel:

I hereby certify that the supporting data is accurate and complete.

Project Manager, AAS Army

i. Signature of Authorized Officials:

I hereby certify that the Justification is accurate and complete to the best of my knowledge and belief, and I determine on the basis of the findings above that the exception to fair opportunity is in accordance with the requirements and is in the best

Contracting Officer, AAS Army
Assisted Acquisition Services

I hereby certify that the Justification is accurate and complete to the best of my knowledge and belief, and I determine on the basis of the findings above that the exception to fair opportunity is in accordance with the requirements and is in the best

Client Executive, AAS Army
Assisted Acquisition Services